

COBRAS AND RELATIVES

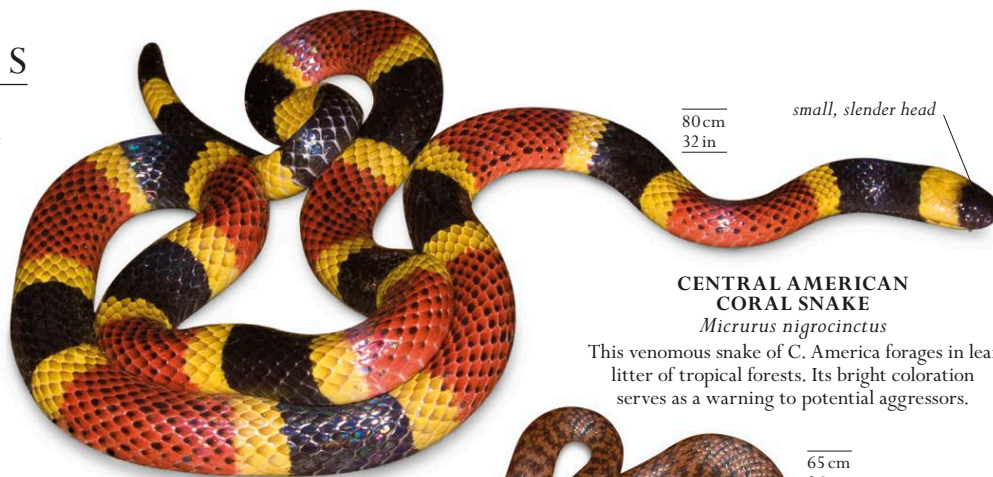
Widely distributed in the tropics, the venomous snakes of the Elapidae have short, permanently erect fangs at the front of the mouth. Varied in body forms, they occupy a wide variety of habitats. Some species lay eggs, while others bear live young.



YELLOW-FACED WHIP SNAKE
Demansia psammophis

Widely distributed across Australia, this slender snake is an active diurnal hunter of lizards. It prefers dry, open habitats.

1.2 m
4 ft



CENTRAL AMERICAN CORAL SNAKE
Micrurus nigrocinctus

This venomous snake of C. America forages in leaf litter of tropical forests. Its bright coloration serves as a warning to potential aggressors.

80 cm
32 in

small, slender head



75 cm
30 in

EASTERN SHIELD-NOSE SNAKE
Aspidelaps scutatus fulafulus

This nocturnal predator of small lizards and mammals is found in southern African savanna. It burrows in sandy soil.



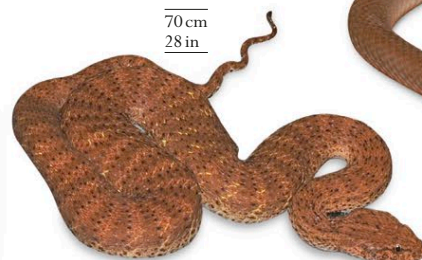
65 cm
26 in

ROSEN'S SNAKE
Suta fasciata

Found in arid areas of Western Australia, this venomous snake hunts for lizards.



spread hood acts as warning



70 cm
28 in

DESERT DEATH ADDER
Acanthophis pyrrhus

This predator of the western deserts of Australia lures its prey of small lizards and mammals by wiggling its tail. It then ambushes them.

2 m
6½ ft

MONOCLED COBRA
Naja kaouthia

Common in S.E. Asia, this large snake hunts rats and other snakes in woodland and paddy fields, often close to human habitation.



50 cm
20 in

RINGED BROWN SNAKE
Pseudonaja modesta

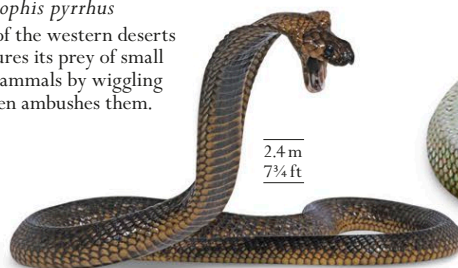
Found in dry, rocky areas in Australia, this venomous snake feeds on small skinks. Its survival is threatened by the loss of its habitat.



35 cm
14 in

SOUTHERN DESERT BANDED SNAKE
Simoselaps bertholdi

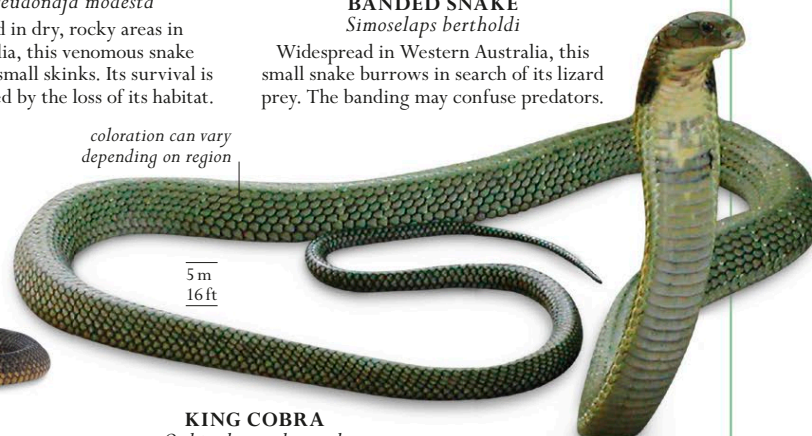
Widespread in Western Australia, this small snake burrows in search of its lizard prey. The banding may confuse predators.



2.4 m
7¾ ft

EGYPTIAN COBRA
Naja haje

This large cobra hunts small vertebrates in the deserts of N. and C. Africa. When threatened, it spreads its hood and raises its head.

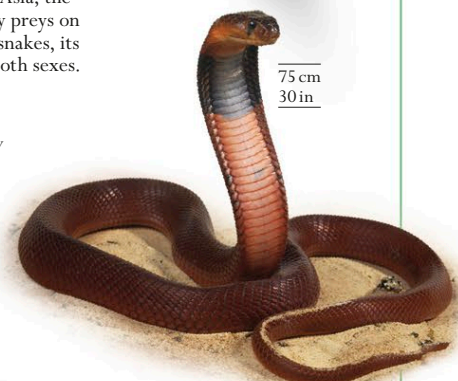


coloration can vary depending on region

5 m
16 ft

KING COBRA
Ophiophagus hannah

A forest species of tropical Asia, the massive king cobra primarily preys on other snakes. Unusually for snakes, its nest of eggs is defended by both sexes.



75 cm
30 in

RED SPITTING COBRA
Naja pallida

This African species not only raises its hood when threatened, but also sprays streams of venom into the face of its aggressor.

smooth scales on brown body